ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

GRADE 8

ENGLISH FIRST ADDITIONAL LANGUAGE

PAPER 3 · WRITING

MARKS: 60 **TIME: 2 hours**

Section A: Essay (30) · Section B: Longer transactional text (20) · Section C: Shorter transactional text (10).

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the CAPS curriculum for Grade 8. It is not a Department of Basic Education examination paper.

INSTRUCTIONS AND INFORMATION

1. This question paper consists of THREE sections: SECTION A: Essay (30 marks), SECTION B: Longer transactional text (20 marks) and SECTION C: Shorter transactional text (10 marks).
2. Answer ONE question from EACH section.
3. Write the number and the title of each question you choose.
4. Plan each piece of writing first (mind map, list or rough draft). Your planning must be handed in, but it will not be marked. Draw a line through it when you have finished.
5. Keep to the number of words asked for in each section.
6. Spend about 60 minutes on Section A, 40 minutes on Section B and 20 minutes on Section C.
7. Write neatly and check your spelling, punctuation and paragraphs.

SECTION A: ESSAY

QUESTION 1

Write an essay of 180–220 words on ONE of the topics below. Give your essay a title.

1.1 **A moment that changed my life** (narrative) [30]

1.2 **The place where I feel most at home** (descriptive – use sense images and figurative language) [30]

1.3 **Social media does more harm than good to teenagers.** Do you agree or disagree? (argumentative – give at least THREE well-explained reasons) [30]

1.4 **"Every expert was once a beginner."** Write an essay about what this saying means to you. You may use your own experiences. (reflective) [30]

1.5 Write a story that BEGINS with these words: *"The lights went out just as the last bell rang …"* (narrative) [30]

TOTAL SECTION A: [30]

SECTION B: LONGER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT

QUESTION 2

Choose ONE of the following. Write 100–120 words. Use the correct format and register.

2.1 **Formal letter.** Write a letter to your principal in which you ask permission to start a homework club for Grade 8 learners. Explain why the club is needed and how it will work. [20]

2.2 **Speech.** You have just been elected as class representative. Write the speech you will give to your class to thank them and explain your plans for the year. [20]

2.3 **Newspaper article.** Learners at your school took part in a clean-up of a nearby river or park. Write an article for your community newspaper about the event. [20]

TOTAL SECTION B: [20]

SECTION C: SHORTER TRANSACTIONAL TEXT

QUESTION 3

Choose ONE of the following. Write 50–70 words. Use the correct format.

3.1 **Notice.** Write a notice for the school notice board inviting learners to the first meeting of a new chess (or debating) club. [10]

3.2 **Instructions.** Write instructions that explain to a younger learner how to make a peanut-butter sandwich, from start to finish. [10]

3.3 **Diary entry.** Write a diary entry about the day you received your final report card of the year. [10]

TOTAL SECTION C: [10]

TOTAL: 60

END OF QUESTION PAPER